

since they are locked, nonprinting layers. Using template layers can be quite helpful when tracing raster pictures or making artwork from scans of mockup designs. To make it simple to notice any pathways you draw over a layer, template layers are muted. The template layer is hidden or printed when the illustration is used in a layout programme like InDesign or QuarkXPress.

You may use templates to build new documents with reusable formatting and design features. For instance, you may construct a template with the necessary artboard size, view settings (such guides), and print choices if you need to design a number of business cards with a similar style. The template may also include particular collections of colour swatches, brushes, and graphic styles as well as symbols for typical design components (such as logos). Templates for business cards, letterhead, brochures, envelopes, certificates, labels, greeting cards, postcards, and websites are among the many that Illustrator has. When a template is chosen using the New From Template command, Illustrator produces a new document with the exact same content and document settings as the template while erasing the template's original file.

Making a template gives you a lot of flexibility for modification and teamwork within your business. A template may be modified by anybody who opens it without risking mistakenly overwriting the original version. For instance, it would be simple to build a template for a business card or a postcard that follows certain rules for the positioning of text.

How can a template layer be created?

A template layer can be used in two different ways. When importing raster artwork into Illustrator as a template, this is the most popular technique to generate a template layer. Select Place > File. Select the artwork you wish to import in the Place dialogue box, check the Template box in the lower-left corner, and then click Place. To ensure that you can see any paths you draw over the file, it is put on a locked layer and muted to 50% by default.

Converting an existing artwork layer into a template is the second approach to creating a template layer. In the Layers panel, double-click a layer name. Select the Template check box in the Layer Options dialogue box that opens, and then click OK. The layer is automatically locked, and the layer symbol in the Visibility column switches from the Visibility icon to the Template icon. It won't be darkened if you turn vector artwork into a template layer.